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FRIDAY
MAY 15, 2026
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UAE Presidential Court

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan received Milojkko Spajic, Prime Minister of Montenegro, yesterday. The leaders reviewed a number of regional and international developments of mutual interest, particularly developments in the Middle East. Prime Minister Spajic reiterated Montenegro's condemnation of the Iranian terrorist attacks targeting civilians and civilian infrastructure in the UAE, noting that they constitute a violation of sovereignty and international norms and undermine regional security and stability.

GCC DECLARES GULF SECURITY 'INDIVISIBLE' AMID TENSIONS

'UAE continues to prioritise political dialogue'

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

Gulf states closed ranks against growing regional threats, with Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) interior ministers declaring the bloc's security "indivisible" after Kuwait arrested alleged cells linked to Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps amid escalating tensions across the region.

Meanwhile, President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan held separate talks over the phone with Qatar Emir Sheikh Tamim Bin Hamad Al Thani and Syrian President Ahmad Al Sharaa, during which they discussed regional developments, coordination efforts and ways to strengthen cooperation among their countries.

Political solutions

Separately, Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, said the UAE continued to prioritise political dialogue despite mounting tensions. "The world is following the important visit of the US President to China and the potential implications it may carry for the regional trajectory," he wrote on X, stressing that Gulf stability could not be achieved

REPORTS OF ISRAELI PM VISIT REJECTED

The UAE has denied reports regarding an alleged visit by Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu to the UAE. It has also denied reports of receiving any Israeli military delegation in the country. "The UAE reaffirms that its relations with Israel are public and conducted within the framework of the well-known and officially declared Abraham Accords, and are not based on non-transparent or unofficial arrangements. Accordingly, any claims regarding unannounced visits or undisclosed arrangements are entirely unfounded unless officially announced by the relevant authorities in the UAE," the UAE statement said.

— Gulf News Report

through confrontation and conflict. He said the UAE would defend its sovereignty "with strength, efficiency and steadfastness" but maintained political solutions was the path to peace, stability and prosperity.

Meeting in Riyadh on Wednesday, the GCC ministers called for intensified coordination against threats targeting GCC states, according to the Saudi Press Agency and Arab News. GCC Secretary-General Jassem Mohamed Albudaiwi said ministers stressed the need for closer cooperation between security agencies as the region grapples with fallout from the ongoing Iran-Israel-US conflict, missile and drone attacks, and threats to shipping routes in the Strait of Hormuz. "The security of the GCC states is indivisible," he said, adding that ministers

emphasised confronting threats to regional stability and combating terrorism "in all its forms".

Sheikh Abdullah Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, UAE's Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Foreign Affairs, said Kuwait's security was inseparable from that of the wider Gulf region, following the arrest of four Iranian nationals accused of attempting to infiltrate Bubiyan Island.

Yesterday, Sheikh Abdullah met David Lammy, the UK's Deputy Prime Minister and Secretary of State for Justice, who condemned the treacherous Iranian terrorist attacks.

UAE condemns attack

Meanwhile, the UAE strongly condemned the terrorist attack on an Indian-flagged vessel off the Oman coast.

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Trump, Xi say Hormuz must remain open

Both countries agree that Iran can never have a nuclear weapon

BEIJING

US President Donald Trump had a "good meeting" with Chinese President Xi Jinping in Beijing yesterday, with the two sides agreeing that the Strait of Hormuz "must remain open to support the free flow of energy".

A White House statement said after their bilateral meeting that the two sides discussed ways to enhance economic cooperation, including expanding market access for American businesses in China. It said that President Xi also made clear China's opposition to the militarisation of the Strait of Hormuz and any effort to charge a toll for its use.

The statement said that both countries agreed that Iran can never have a nuclear weapon.

"President Trump had a good meeting with President Xi of China. The two sides discussed ways to enhance economic cooperation between our two countries, including expanding market access for American businesses into China and increasing

A White House statement said that President Xi also made clear China's opposition to the militarisation of the Strait of Hormuz and any effort to charge a toll for its use.

Chinese investment into our industries," the White House said in a post on X. It said leaders from many of the United States' largest companies joined a portion of the meeting.

The statement said that President Xi expressed interest in purchasing more American oil to reduce dependence on Strait of Hormuz. "The two sides agreed that the Strait of Hormuz must remain open to support the free flow of energy. President Xi also made clear China's opposition to the militarisation of the Strait and any effort to charge a toll for its use, and he expressed interest in purchasing more American oil to reduce China's dependence on the Strait in the future. Both countries agreed that Iran can never have a nuclear weapon," it added.

— Agencies

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ENTERTAINMENT

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Indians eye more savings on gold

Higher import duties widen savings for those carrying jewellery home

DUBAI

BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

India's decision to raise import duties on gold and silver to 15 per cent from 6 per cent is driving more UAE-based Indian families to complete jewellery

purchases in Dubai before travelling home for summer holidays and weddings.

Jewellers say the widened duty gap could make gold and jewellery in the GCC roughly 12 per cent cheaper than in India, especially as global bullion prices remain near record highs.

The shift is becoming particularly relevant during the July-August NRI wedding season. Under Indian customs rules, women can carry up to 40 grams of gold jewellery duty-free, while men can carry

up to 20 grams. That means a husband and wife can together carry 60 grams duty-free, while larger family combinations can legally carry up to 140 grams or more depending on eligibility.

At current Dubai rates yesterday, 140 grams of 22K gold would be worth more than Dh73,000. Industry estimates suggest the widening Dubai-India price gap could translate into savings worth several thousand dirhams on wedding and family jewellery purchases.

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